

APPIAN INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

ROLE: Software Engineer

About Appian

Appian Corporation is a leading American enterprise software company headquartered in McLean, Virginia. It specializes in providing a low-code automation platform that enables businesses to rapidly develop applications with minimal hand-coding. Appian's platform combines process mining, workflow automation, case management, and artificial intelligence to streamline complex business operations across industries.

The interview process consisted of 4 rounds:

1. **Online Assessment**
2. **Technical Interview – 1**
3. **Technical Interview – 2**
4. **HR Interview**

Online Assessment:

The Online Assessment had been conducted in Glider AI platform, which had a strict audio and video proctoring. It consisted of 3 coding questions focused on **data structures and algorithms**. All the candidates were asked same questions

1. **First and Last occurrence of a given element in an array:** Given a sorted array, determine the starting and ending position of a target value.
2. **Insert new Interval:** Merge a new interval into an existing list of sorted, non-overlapping intervals. The result should remain sorted and merged if overlaps. (Refer Insert New Interval in Leetcode)
3. **Find duplicate and missing elements and return the status of the team:** An array from 1 to n contains exactly 1 duplicate and missing number. A list of teams will be provided, each team consists of team IDs return which team consists of both the missing and duplicate number

A total of 42 candidates were shortlisted after this round.

Technical Round 1

The interviewer began by asking me to introduce myself, followed by a brief introduction about himself. Then, we directly moved into a **pair-coding** session. This round was more focused on logical problem-solving than pure DSA.

Problem 1 – Mobile Battery Drain Simulation

I was given an array representing properties of multiples phones in a chunks of four elements each:

- Index 0 -> Mobile ID
- Index 1 -> Current Battery %
- Index 2 -> Battery Drain rate per minute
- Index 3 -> Relaxation time (in minutes) [Assume I use phone for 1 minute standardly and take break for phone[3] mins]

This pattern continues for every phone. Determine which phone will get discharged first considering its use-and-relax cycle.

Example: For [1,4,1,4,2,10,2,1]

For 4% battery drains 1% every minute you use. After 1 minute of use, rest for 4 minutes. So it would totally last for 16 minutes. For phone 2, 10% battery drains 2 per minute and is used continuously without break. So it would last for 5 minutes.

I initially gave a wrong solution and simulated a few test cases. One of the cases failed, I asked for more time, rethought my approach, and derived a new solution which passed all the test-cases.

For each phone, calculate the time at which phone hits 0%. Track the minimum and return the corresponding mobile ID.

Problem 2 – Longest Word based on 'BIG' characters.

Given a list of strings, find the one with the maximum number of characters from word "BIG" irrespective of the order. Example length of 'bible' is 2 (since 'b' and 'l' 2 characters from "BIG" are present) and length of "bargain" is 3 (since all 3 characters from "BIG" are present).

Project Discussion: I had listed AWS and a project involving AWS in my resume. The interviewer asked multiple questions on

- Specific AWS Services used
- Deployment Architecture
- AWS encryption techniques.

We discussed on some-other remaining projects from the resume.

Technical Round 2:

This round felt more like a hybrid between technical and HR. The questions were focused on Achievements and Hackathons I participated in, What I learned from those events, The subject where I scored the lowest and why, and what I could have done to improve that performance. Also some questions on core CS DBMS were asked

He asked me to explain one of my favourite projects. I explained its goals, tech stack, contributions and key takeaways. So the round ended with the interviewer asking whether I did have some questions for him. I asked some questions related to the SE role in Appian.

After round 2, 24 of us got shortlisted.

HR Round:

The final round was straightforward and more focused on my **academic record**.

Questions asked:

1. CGPA (mine is 8.68), 12th grade score
2. Whether I attended JEE or not (I didn't) and the reason why
3. What LLMS I use and my knowledge on Java and spring boot and resources I used to learn them.

And again the interview ended with me asking questions to the interviewer.

Totally 12 students got selected as SE interns in Appian

Key Takeaways:

1. The coding questions focused on logical thinking rather than algorithms.
2. Follow Striver's A-Z Sheet and C.O.D.E intern materials for DSA preparation.

3. Be thorough with your resume and the projects you have included.
4. Learn about the Company before the interview and their primary tech-stack.
5. Before submitting the form, verify your details whether it's been entered correctly.

All the best!!

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Best Regards,

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